

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: You deserve happiness too!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about unlikely events or fairly certain conditions that will be fulfilled in the present, past or future in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write an informal letter.
- I can write about personality traits, love and marriage.
- I can talk about two actions together.

Ask your partner:

- Have you been matched with a partner by your friends and family before? Why or why not?
- What kind of person do you think they would match you with? Explain.

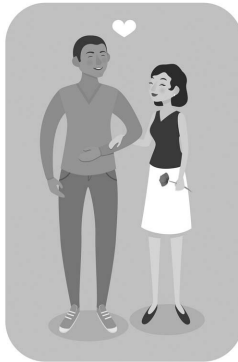




Let's Explore!

Beth's cousin, Richard, wants to share his experience **working*** with a matchmaker. He thinks Beth may benefit from her intuitiveness.

* "Working" is acting as a verb in the sentence.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear Beth,

How's life been treating you lately? You must be close to finishing your Law degree. I know the family is really proud of what you have achieved. Stop showing the rest of us up! Anyway, do you remember the girl I met through Margaret Vanderkamp, the matchmaker, a couple months ago? Well, she definitely has a knack for finding true love. Matchmaking is her business and I highly recommend her. She was able to connect me with the love of my life, Rhonda. She and I have been inseparable ever since our first date. She's gorgeous, talented and has a real zest for life. She laughs at my corny jokes and even thinks that my "portly" frame is adorable. Quite frankly, I am besotted with her. Don't be surprised if you get a wedding invitation in the mail before Christmas.

That being said ... You and I are close, more like brother and sister than cousins. You've told me about past broken relationships and your non-existent social life. I understand that school has been your priority in the last couple years but I think it's time to turn over a new leaf. Get back in the game and start dating. Better yet, why not leave it to the experts? Living your life without someone to share it with can be lonely. Give Margaret a chance of unearthing a hidden gem for you. Before you think of dismissing my idea, why don't you give me a call and we can chat about the process.

You deserve the same happiness in your personal life.

Your cousin,

Robert





Let's Practice!

Robert offers his cousin some friendly advice.

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. Living your life without someone to share it with can be lonely.
2. Give Margaret a chance of unearthing a hidden gem for you.
3. Well, she definitely has a knack for finding true love.
4. Matchmaking is her business, and I highly recommend her.
5. Before you think of dismissing my idea, why don't you give me a call and we can chat about the process.



Let's Practice!

Now, it's your turn to write an informal letter to a friend or relative.

Instructions: Write a 150-170 word informal letter to a friend or family member about finding true love using a matchmaker. Include an informal greeting and closing. Start with general sentences and questions that provide an introduction to the letter. Then, explain how you met your partner. Describe the person's qualities and attributes. Describe your relationship. Write about why you think this person is perfect for you. Conclude the letter with friendly advice. Use short sentences. Include contractions and casual language.





Extension Activity

Taking things one step further.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 150-170 word informal letter to a close relative and invite your relative to your wedding.
- Give them some details about your future husband/wife.
- Describe your relationship.
- Explain where the wedding will be held.
- Include the date and time of the event.
- Use an informal greeting and closing.
- Use casual language, contractions and short sentences.
- When complete, read the letter aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write an informal letter to a close relative.

☐ ☐

I give details about my future spouse in a letter.

☐ ☐

I use casual language, contractions and short sentences in an informal letter.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to treat** (verb): to happen/ to go in a certain way
e.g. How's life been treating you lately?
- **to show someone up** (expression): to embarrass someone by being superior
e.g. Stop showing the rest of us up!
- **inseparable** (adjective): not able to be separated
e.g. She and I have been inseparable ever since our first date.
- **portly** (adjective): having a round and somewhat fat body
e.g. She laughs at my corny jokes and even thinks that my "portly" frame is adorable.
- **back in the game** (expression): to return to regular activities
e.g. Get back in the game and start dating.
- **to unearth** (verb): to find or discover something or someone
e.g. Give Margaret a chance of unearthing that special someone.
- **gem** (noun): something special
e.g. He is such a gem!





Learning Points

Writing Tip: Using Clauses With *-ing*

You can use the *-ing* form as a noun, an adjective or a verb.

For example:

Smoking is dangerous. (noun)

He spends his summers at a baseball **training** camp. (adjective)

I'm **working** late today. (verb)

When you use *-ing* as a noun, you sometimes use an article before it or sometimes you don't use it.

For example:

Editing takes a great deal of concentration.

The selling of this land signals major changes in the area.

You can also use it as a noun phrase.

For example:

Giving a speech is somewhat daunting.

Riding my bicycle to work is invigorating.

You can use the *-ing* form before a noun when it is an adjective.

For example:

We went to a **welcoming party** at the airport.

We're going to a **housewarming party** next week.

You use the *-ing* form after prepositions.

For example:

Before coming, you need to speak to Tanya.

After finding out where they were going, I decided to tag along.

I'm not looking forward **to seeing** the dentist.

Examples:

- *Living your life without someone to share it with can be lonely.*
- *Give Margaret a chance of unearthing a hidden gem for you.*
- *Before you think of dismissing my idea, why don't you give me a call and we can chat about the process.*
- *Get back in the game and start dating.*





Learning Points

Writing an Informal Letter

You write informal letters to friends and family. They often include casual language and are written more like a conversation rather than an organized piece of writing.

The most common salutation in an informal letter is *Dear*_____, followed by a comma.

The first part of the letter should explain to the recipient why you are writing to them.

The second part of the letter consists of the message you want to get across.

The final part of the letter is where everything is wrapped up.
Informal letters can end with a casual closing.

For example: *Love*, or *Missing you lots*,

Informal letters convey emotions and feelings unlike formal letters. They can also include contractions and short sentences.

